James Praise

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

GTM engineer who builds and runs the systems that find accounts, reach them and turn replies into pipeline. At FunnelEnvy I ran cold email and LinkedIn outreach for five US and European client accounts at once on Clay, n8n, Claude Code and Smartlead. I built my own prospect data engine in Python, and I keep a record of what broke in it and what I changed. I run my GTM work in Claude Code, including 82 marketing and GTM agent skills, 34 of them published on GitHub. My work has contributed to $10M+ in qualified pipeline. A sample hiring-signal scan I built for Niuro is at jamespraise.xyz/work/niuro/proof.

Selected Achievements:

- Ran cold outbound for five FunnelEnvy client accounts at once. The average client reached 1,000 companies and 3,000 contacts a month, with 102 replies, 10 meetings held and $151,962 in pipeline created a month.
- Lifted outbound reply rates 27% and enterprise meeting bookings 31% at FunnelEnvy by testing new angles, audiences and account-based plays against reply data.
- Built a free-first prospect data engine of 40+ standard-library Python modules across 10+ sources. One live run sourced 409 companies and produced 271 verified emails and 267 send-ready leads after tiering.
- Added a live deliverability check (MillionVerifier over HTTPS) after two database-verified addresses bounced and my own SMTP checker failed on a blocked port 25, and set a tiered send rule after website-scraped emails tested 53% good against 71% for database-enriched ones.
- Generated 1,331 marketing qualified leads in six months at Bujeti and 1,646 at Cecure Intelligence Limited, across inbound, outbound and lifecycle.

KEY SKILLS

GTM Engineering: Signal-based account selection, Clay workflow design, waterfall enrichment, email verification, web scraping (job boards, directories, open data), API integrations and webhooks, n8n automation, Claude Code and Model Context Protocol (MCP) integrations

Engineering: Python, JavaScript, REST APIs, JSON, Git and GitHub, Large Language Model (LLM) prompting and output review, HTML and CSS

Commercial: Outbound strategy, ICP research, offer and copy testing, experiment design (hypothesis, metric, decision date), weekly reporting, cost per lead and cost per meeting tracking

Tools: Clay, Smartlead, Instantly, lemlist, LinkedIn Sales Navigator, Apollo.io, HubSpot, Prospeo, LeadMagic, MillionVerifier, Hunter, Apify, Outscraper, n8n, Zapier, Claude Code, ChatGPT, Looker Studio

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Growth, GTM & Demand Generation Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 – April 2026
FunnelEnvy (B2B, Growth Marketing Service Provider for US & European SaaS)

- Owned cold email and LinkedIn outreach for five client accounts at once, from audience research and offer to copy, sending and weekly performance reviews with each client.
- Designed the AI-enabled outbound stack: Clay for scraping, enrichment and orchestration, n8n for workflows, Smartlead for sending, Claude Code for personalization.
- Per client average: 9,000 emails, 102 replies (3.4% of contacts), 20 accounts saying yes and 10 meetings a month, with $27,353 in closed revenue a month at 11.6x total spend.
- Developed the account-based marketing playbook on Clay, ExactBuyer and Instantly. Enterprise meeting bookings rose 31% and MQL-to-SQL conversion rose 28%.
- Built the ICEEE experimentation framework and the reporting stack (HubSpot, GA4, Looker Studio, Lightdash) that cut reporting time 50%.

Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 – April 2026
Reform (SaaS, MarTech)

- Rebuilt lifecycle automation and the product-led funnel, increasing trial-to-paid conversion by 21% and trial activation by 34%.
- Led the move from Userlist to Brevo, including DKIM, DMARC and SPF setup, list cleanup with Kickbox and n8n workflow validation.

GTM Engineering Consultant | Marketing In Action (MIA) | April 2024 – Present
Marketing In Action (GTM Engineering for SaaS, B2B & Product-led)

- Built the outbound and data infrastructure MIA runs on: source-adapter Python scrapers, enrichment and verification pipelines, a self-built HTML QA and preview tool, and AI-personalized sequences sent through warmed inboxes.
- Sourced from Google Maps, Clutch, SEC EDGAR Form D filings, venture portfolios, app stores and open-data sets, with enrichment through Prospeo and LeadMagic.
- Set up n8n alerts that connect Brevo, Smartlead and Resend for lead sync, and connected Claude Code to live tools through MCP servers (n8n, Webflow, Google Analytics).

Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti (YC W23) | Sep 2023 – Feb 2024
Bujeti (SaaS, FinTech, Spend & Expense Management Platform)

- Built B2B lead generation across inbound, outbound and lifecycle automation.

- Generated 1,331 MQLs in six months and scaled B2B customers by 500%.

Demand Generation Manager (progression: Sales Manager, Partnerships Manager, Head of Growth & Marketing, Chief Revenue Officer) | Cecure Intelligence Limited | Jun 2022 – Sep 2023
Cecure Intelligence Limited (B2B, Technology & Training Provider)

- Led revenue operations across Sub-Saharan Africa, generating 1,646 MQLs and 406 SQLs.
- Secured $326K in sales velocity and managed $3.4M+ in open deals.

Founder & Builder | Marketing In Action Newsletter | Apr 2024 – Present
Marketing In Action (Newsletter, Media & Community Platform)

- Documented GTM automation workflows on Clay, n8n, Zapier and AI agents, and open-sourced marketing agent skills at github.com/realjaymes/marketingagentskills.
- Grew the newsletter to 5,000+ subscribers with a 47% average open rate.

Marketing, Growth & GTM Roles | Multiple Companies | 2018 – 2022
B2B, SaaS, Ecommerce, Agencies & Service Businesses

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation | Miva Open University (2026)
- Outbound Automation & AI GTM Engineering Certification | Clay (2025)
- Product Marketing PMMC™ Certification | Product Marketing Alliance (2025)
- BSc. Biochemistry | University of Lagos (2018)
- Certifications: Clay (Prompt Engineering, Workflow Automation), HubSpot (SEO, SEM, Content Marketing), Google (Digital Analytics, Display Ads)